

# Staying Active After 60

Staying active after 60 helps protect strength, balance, confidence, and independence. Choose activities that feel safe, social, and enjoyable enough to repeat.

## Build a balanced routine

A good routine includes aerobic activity, strength, balance, and flexibility. Brisk walking supports stamina. Strength exercises help with carrying groceries, climbing stairs, and getting up from a chair. Balance practice lowers the chance of falls. Gentle stretching keeps movement comfortable.

| Focus       | Simple example                                  | How often to include          |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Stamina     | Brisk walking or cycling                        | Most days if comfortable      |
| Strength    | Sit-to-stand, wall push-ups                     | 2+ days weekly                |
| Balance     | Heel-to-toe walk, single-leg stand near support | Several short sessions weekly |
| Flexibility | Calf, shoulder, and back stretches              | After activity                |

## Social options can help

Many people keep going when activity is social. Morning group walks, brisk walking with neighbours, tai chi or qigong style classes, and senior-friendly exercise sessions can make movement more enjoyable. Community centres run senior-friendly classes, so check what is nearby and suitable for your level.

If you prefer privacy, start at home with chair-based strength, gentle stretching, or a short corridor walk. You can still invite one friend or family member to join once a week.

## Pace yourself

Warm up, start slowly, and increase one thing at a time: either duration, speed, or frequency. On hot or hazy days, choose indoor routes, mall walking, or a gentler home routine. Wear supportive shoes, bring water, and avoid uneven paths when visibility or footing is poor.

Use the talk test. During moderate activity, you should be able to talk in short sentences. If you are gasping, dizzy, or in pain, stop and rest.

## Make safety part of the habit

Keep walkways at home clear, use handrails on stairs, and choose well-lit routes. For balance practice, stand near a stable support. If you use a walking aid, use it consistently instead of treating it as optional.

## Key points

- Include stamina, strength, balance, and flexibility.
- Morning group activities and social classes can improve motivation.
- Brisk walking, tai chi or qigong style classes, and senior-friendly community centre sessions are practical options.
- Pace yourself and adjust for heat, rain, or hazy conditions.
- Stop if you feel chest discomfort, dizziness, or unusual breathlessness.

## When to talk to a health professional

Speak to a doctor or physiotherapist if you have falls, pain that limits movement, chest discomfort, dizziness, recent surgery, or you are unsure which activities are safe for you.

This guide is sample content written for the LiveWell Coach workshop. It is general information, not medical

advice. If you have symptoms or a health condition, speak to a doctor.